90-Day Implementation Roadmap

A practical plan for putting reasonable fraud prevention procedures in place over three months, in line with the six principles of the Home Office guidance on the failure to prevent fraud offence and the Government Functional Standard GovS 013. Adjust the timing to the size and risk of your organisation.

Days 1–30: Mobilise and assess

Action	Suggested owner	Done
Name the board-level person accountable for fraud prevention.	Board / Chair	
Agree the scope: business areas, subsidiaries, and the agents and contractors who act for you.	Accountable person	
Complete the fraud risk assessment and record each risk with an owner.	Finance lead	
Make sure staff, contractors and the public can report concerns, including anonymously.	HR / Governance	
Start a log of suspected fraud incidents and their outcomes.	Counter fraud lead	

Days 31–60: Design and implement

Action	Suggested owner	Done
Agree an action plan for every high residual risk, with deadlines.	Risk owners	
Approve the counter fraud policy and response plan, and the gifts, hospitality and conflicts of interest policies.	Board	
Tighten core controls: segregation of duties, approval limits, call-back checks on bank detail changes.	Finance lead	
Introduce proportionate due diligence for new suppliers and other associated persons.	Procurement lead	
Start fraud awareness training for all staff, beginning with high-risk roles.	HR / Training	

Days 61–90: Monitor and report

Action	Suggested owner	Done
Run one detection exercise in the highest-risk area, such as data matching on payroll or suppliers.	Counter fraud lead	
Bring training completion to at least 80% of staff.	HR / Training	
Review the risk register and progress on each action plan.	Accountable person	
Report to the board: risks, actions, training, incidents, losses and recoveries.	Accountable person	
Set the cycle: quarterly register reviews and a full reassessment at least every year.	Board	

Evidence to keep

Keep dated records as you go. They are what demonstrates reasonable procedures if they are ever tested:

- Board minutes showing the accountable person, policy approval and oversight
- The fraud risk assessment and risk register, with owners and action plans
- Due diligence records for suppliers and associated persons
- Training records and completion rates
- Reporting routes, the incident log and how each case was handled
- Monitoring, detection and board reports

This roadmap is general guidance. It supports, but does not replace, legal advice or a formal GovS 013 assurance review.
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